

8.2 The Essentials Of Blogging

All blogs hosts offer the basic tools needed to maintain a diary or journal: you need not worry about learning to code. The user interfaces are intuitive, and anyone can master the basics with ease. Adding images and links to other pages are all easily accomplished. Putting up the page online, also called Publishing, in most cases, just involves a mouse click. Previous blog entries are archived for easy access.

While maintaining a blog is similar to maintaining a Web site, people these days tend to prefer blogging sites because of the simplicity. The toughest part of maintaining a diary, of course, is finding something interesting to record.

8.3 Using Blogger

8.3.1 Creating a Blog

Blogger can be accessed at www.blogger.com. You need to sign up to be able to create a blog. You can sign in to Blogger using your Gmail ID. Alternatively, you can also create a distinct Blogger ID.

Like any Web page, your blog will have a URL—the address by which others will access it. Thanks to the popularity of blogger.com, the chances of finding your preferred blog URL are slim—for example, if your name is as common as Rajesh, forget about rajesh.blogspot.com—in fact, even forget about rajesh1.blogspot.com! So, once you have compromised on a URL of your choice, you are presented with a clutch of page styles to choose from. The styles differ in the font, colour, and layout, and there is a preview of each. After you have finalised the page style, you can ask Google to go ahead and create the blog. “Creating” the blog is nothing but publishing a Web page online. The page, with the style you choose, could have been manually coded using HTML and scripts. Fortunately, all the necessary functions are carried out in the background, leaving your to twiddle your thumbs as the process